

Leading Change — Execution

10-Week Leadership Development Program

Daily Habit	Weekly Deliverable	Reading
Block 90 minutes this week for Quadrant II activity (important but not urgent: relationship building, strategic thinking, initiative planning).	Map the relationships needed for your change initiative: supporters, neutrals, and resisters. Have one listening conversation with a resister.	The 7 Habits, Habit 3: Put First Things First — Quadrant II thinking (Covey) + Connect — Relationship map for change

Core Concept

Having a vision is necessary but not sufficient. Execution is where most change initiatives die. Covey's time management matrix identifies four quadrants based on urgency and importance. Most leaders are consumed by Quadrant I (urgent and important — crises) and Quadrant III (urgent but not important — other people's emergencies). They spend almost no time in Quadrant II: the important-but-not-urgent work that creates long-term impact.

Leading a change initiative is a Quadrant II activity. It rarely screams at you. It will not send you a calendar invite. You have to protect time for it deliberately — because if you don't, the urgent will always crowd out the important.

Execution also requires relational work. Change happens through people. Before you can move people, you need to understand where they stand. Your resisters are not obstacles — they are information. Their resistance often contains legitimate concerns that, if addressed, will make your initiative stronger.

""The key is not to prioritize what's on your schedule, but to schedule your priorities.""

— Stephen R. Covey

Framework: The Time Management Matrix

URGENT NOT URGENT

IMPORTANT Q1: Crisis Q2: Strategy, relationships,
firefighting prevention, development

← SPEND MORE TIME HERE

NOT Q3: False Q4: Waste, busy work,
IMPORTANT urgency, mindless scrolling
interruptions

Most leaders spend 70%+ in Q1 and Q3. High-impact leaders protect Q2 time by scheduling it like a meeting — non-negotiable.

Daily Practice

- Weekly Q2 block: Put a 90-minute 'Deep Work — Change Initiative' block on your calendar. Treat it like a board meeting.
- Resister conversation script: 'I know this change has implications for you and your team. I'd like to understand your concerns before we move forward. Would you be willing to share your perspective?'
- Stakeholder map: List everyone affected by your change. Rate them: Champion / Supportive / Neutral / Skeptical / Opposing. Plan your approach to each.
- First small win: Identify one visible, achievable milestone in your change initiative that can happen within 30 days. First wins build momentum and credibility.

Leadership Scenarios

Scenario 1

You're trying to implement a new onboarding program. Your two most senior team leads think it's unnecessary and have been passive in their support.

Reflection: How do you have a productive listening conversation with them? What are you trying to understand?

Scenario 2

Three months into a change initiative, progress has stalled. People are reverting to old behaviors and the initial enthusiasm has faded.

Reflection: What are the most likely causes? What does execution recovery look like?

Weekly Reflection Prompts

Set aside 20 minutes at the end of this week to write your responses. These are for you — be honest.

Reflection 1: Track your time for one week. What percentage is in each quadrant? What does the data tell you?

Reflection:

Reflection 2: Who is the most important 'resister' to your change initiative? What do you understand about their concerns? What do you still need to learn?

Reflection:

Reflection 3: What is the first small win you can create for your change initiative in the next 30 days? Who needs to see it succeed?

Reflection:

Weekly Habit Tracker

Day	Done?	Notes / Observations
Monday	■	
Tuesday	■	
Wednesday	■	
Thursday	■	
Friday	■	
Saturday	■	
Sunday	■	

End-of-Week Summary

Reflection: What was my biggest leadership learning this week?

Reflection: What will I carry forward into next week?

Reflection: One relationship I invested in this week: